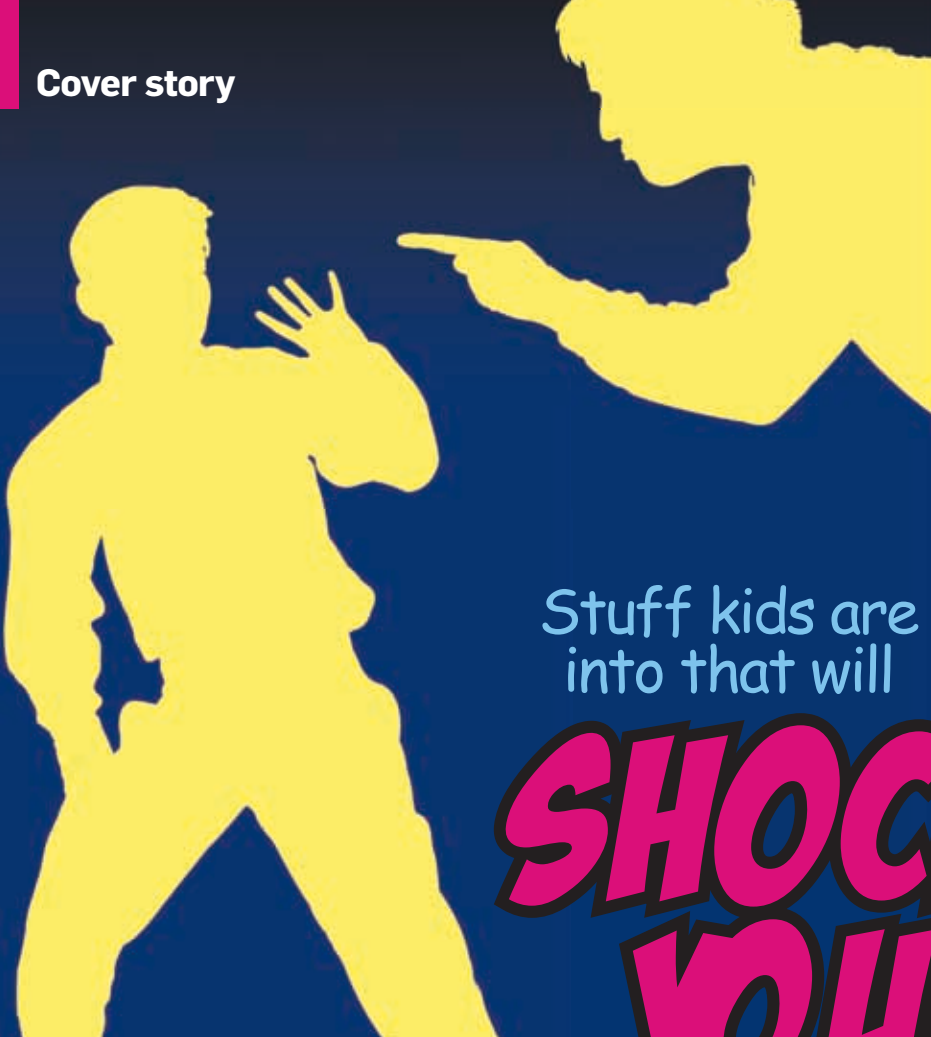




Stuff kids are
into that will

**SHOCK
YOU**

Mithun Mohandas
readersletters@thinkdigit.com

This page here shall not contain any imagery for the sole reason being that its contents are enough to melt your brain. When we were kids, there would be that one guy or gal who'd be the most messed up amongst the entire lot, and then each successive generation turned out to up the ante. So in a way the kids these days are unequivocally up to some ridiculously messed up antics.

I'm more extreme than thou . . .

Whether its the competitive spirit in them or ego working it's devious ways, kids try to outperform their peers in one aspect or the other. While in an academic environment, this may be good, it certainly isn't when it is concerned with establishing a hierarchy amongst their peers. We have children undergoing initiation rites to become part of a group. Some of these involve physical violence towards people, particularly towards members of minority communities. This act could only be considered an euphemism if we are to list out what all youngsters are made to do. Recently, in

the UK, arrests were made in a graveyard vandalism case, the surprising part was that all the suspects were youngsters aged 14-15. While this is shocking to an extent, it doesn't compare to the following situation. On an all too popular message board on the internet, one of the members posted an image of a skull and asked for suggestions as to "What should I do with it?". He did as asked and placed his reproductive organ into the orbital cavity of the said cranium. And yes, he posted images of the act.

An innard for an i . . .

It may not necessarily be about the money but when it is, kids have a way of finding ways to earn some quick cash. Specially since the almighty search engines are more than willing to throw up numerous ways to do so. Yes, we're pretty sure you must've read about Mr.Zheng from China who sold one of his kidneys for RMB 20,000 (₹1,57,903) so that he could get an iPad 2. Was he approached by a shady agent for his kidney? Nope, it was the other way around. One quick search and he found

an advert online which offered him the money. Even though their government undertakes measures to curb this practice, "Organ Tourism" is a common practise and innocent kids are eager enough to offer up their organs for a quick buck.

Gory imagery . . .

If you've ever been in an accident then you know that it makes for situation that you would never want to be in again. The experience itself is disturbing, the mere thought of reliving the same is enough to send some people in shock. Now imagine a site where people go and post these images... of dismembered people & animals, accidents, abuse, murder victims, etc. If anything has to do with death then there's a good probability that there will be something pertaining to the subject posted there. Beheading videos by extremists or that of execution of prisoners are also found in plenty. Since the theme of these web sites is downright disgusting, the idea of moderators policing this site is alien. If at all, the moderators would ensure the content remains consistent to the theme which incidentally is to 'showcase the truth without censorship'.

Virtual cash of a different kind

"The birthplace of Anonymous", "the birthplace of memes", etc are some of the phrases that this web site is described by, more commonly known as "4chan". Ranked 998 with majority of its users being in the age group 18-24, an English image-board where users come to discuss a variety of topics. On this forum is one section known as "Random" or /b/. This particular section offers complete anonymity to its posters. The result? A mix of good and bad. On one hand, Anonymous leads the crusade for freedom of the internet while on the other hand, a peculiar behaviour that has arisen is a barter system that uses nude images of kids as an object that can be traded to get anything done. By anything, we mean anything that any of its anonymous members are capable of. Need someone's profile on a social network hacked? Bank account? DDos any website? Produce "fresh" nudity and maybe someone might do the job for you. Needless to say, economics plays its part and the demand for more "images" rises. ■